Lillooah's wartime activities, however, did not end with her all-out effort to supply adequate railroad means of transport. The building of other vehicular bodies was undertaken, and hundreds upon hundreds of ambulances, water-cars, tanks and lorries passed incessantly out of the gates. Other minor jobs of major wartime importance were heavy orders for 'dahs' and tent pegs. These were accurately complied with and rushed away for service to distant theatres of war.

And so we find Lillooah, untraceable on any map, to have shared not inconsiderably in the defeating of the Axis powers. The trains she built convoyed troops and supplies to almost every part of India; the wagons carried guns, machines and ammunition; the ambulances and water-cars she built did valuable front-line service; and her tanks went into action against the enemy.

MACARTHUR'S—INDIA GETS WAR LOCOMOTIVES FROM THE US

The war gave rise to many unprecedented changes, even in the design of the locomotives that used to run on Indian soil. During the war years of 1939–45, the traditional suppliers of steam locomotives from Britain could not meet the Indian Railways' requirement and the locomotives were ordered in large numbers from North America. These were popularly known as MAWD (MacArthur's War Design), or simply WD (war department) locomotives. The success of this wartime design with strong American features greatly influenced the post-war standard designs on Indian Railways.

These locomotives had bar frames, outside cylinders, alligator-type crossheads, cast bogies for tenders and other prominent American design features. Their satisfactory working influenced the post-war standard designs on Indian Railways. [120]

Named after the famous American World War II General Donald MacArthur, the locomotives had a wheel configuration 2-8-2 (Pony Couple Radial). The MAWD was built in 1942 by the Baldwin Locomotive Works, the premier locomotive builder in the United States. MAWDs were a common sight on the metre gauge lines of the Southern Railway, in the good old days of steam. They were especially suited for shunting duties.

They were not permitted to run at high velocities because their bogie tenders could derail at such speeds; otherwise they were fine locomotives. No railway has publicly expressed gratitude to the United States for supplying locomotives for free. During World War II, the US built thousands of steam locomotives and supplied them to various Allied countries. [121]